

Terracotta Customer Survey Analysis Report

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Introduction

Terracotta recently conducted a customer survey to better understand what drives purchasing decisions among plant buyers. The purpose of this analysis is to answer three key business questions:

1. Which types of plants are most frequently purchased by customers?
 2. Are there any factors in choosing to buy a plant that are consistently important to customers?
 3. What information should we advertise to boost Terracotta sales?
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Frequent Plant Purchases

Using Terracotta’s plant-info reference sheet, we matched each customer’s selected plant type to its associated maintenance level and whether it is safe for pets and children.

Plant Types by Maintenance Level

Survey results show that **low-maintenance plants** are by far the most frequently purchased. Nearly **80%** of respondents selected plants that fall into this category.

PivotTable: Plant Purchases by Maintenance Level

Maintenance Level	% of Responses
High-Maintenance	5.07%

Low-Maintenance	79.26%
Medium-Maintenance	15.67%
Grand Total	100.00%

Plant Safety for Pets and Children

An overwhelming **99.54%** of customers prefer plants that are safe for pets and children, indicating a strong household-centered concern when choosing a plant.

PivotTable: Plant Purchases by Safety

Safety Classification	% of Responses
Safe for Pets & Children	99.54%
Toxic	0.46%
Grand Total	100.00%

Customer Priorities in Choosing Plants

Each free-response answer about the most important factor in choosing a plant was categorized into themes. The following table presents the breakdown of customer priorities based on this categorization.

PivotTable: Reasons for Purchase

Reason for Purchase	% of Responses
Care Requirements	26.73%
Pet-Friendly or Safe for Children	25.81%
Benefits (e.g. air quality, mood)	18.89%
Rare or Unique Species	12.44%
Size	11.06%

Price	5.07%
Grand Total	100.00%

These results show that care needs and safety are the two top decision-making factors, followed by interest in the plant’s benefits and uniqueness.

Key Takeaways

- **Low-maintenance plants** account for nearly **four out of every five** purchases.
- **Pet and child safety** is a near-universal concern among customers.
- **Care requirements** and **safety** are the most important purchase drivers, making up over half of all stated reasons.
- **Aesthetic and emotional benefits** (like mood, air quality, or rare beauty) are also notable motivators.

Marketing and Online Strategy Recommendations

Terracotta can use these insights to align product presentation and messaging with what matters most to customers.

We recommend structuring the online store with easy-to-use filters for **Low Maintenance**, **Pet/Kid-Safe**, and **Light Requirements**, allowing customers to quickly find the plants that best match their preferences. Product pages should include clear icons that display care level, light needs, and pet safety.

Marketing messages—especially across social media, email campaigns, and digital ads—should emphasize ease of care and household safety. For example, messages like “Perfect for Busy Plant Parents” or “Safe for Pets and Loved Ones” would resonate strongly with customer priorities. Additionally, content such as care guides and blog posts focused on beginner plants and pet-safe options can further support Terracotta’s brand positioning and improve sales.

Conclusion

The survey data provides a clear direction for Terracotta's product and marketing strategy. By emphasizing low-maintenance, pet- and child-safe plants and promoting care simplicity in both design and messaging, Terracotta can meet customer expectations, improve shopping experience, and increase online plant sales.